

Dudhsagar Falls

Location The Western Ghats of Karnataka-Goa, southwest India

One of India's highest waterfalls, this four-tiered cascade is produced by the Mandovi River as it plunges 1,020ft (310m) from the Deccan Traps (see p.353) in the Western Ghats. The falls are ordinary in the dry season, but their character changes completely during monsoons, between June and September. *Dudhsagar* means "sea of milk" in the local Konkani language,

a reference to the creamy-white appearance of the water as it pours down the near-vertical rock face.

Hogenakkal Falls

Location Karnataka-Tamil Nadu border, southern India

Hogenakkal means "smoking rocks," a reference to the clouds of spray that hang in the air above the falls. While the 65ft (20m) that the Kaveri River drops does not sound great, the width of the waterfall is.

As the river approaches "India's Niagara," it forks into multiple streams that gush into a narrow gorge from both sides. Hogenakkal is at its most spectacular during monsoons (July–August).

Yarlung Tsangpo Grand Canyon

Location The Eastern Himalayas, China (Tibet) and India

Arguably the world's deepest canyon, the difference in

elevation between the Yarlung Tsangpo River and the mountain peaks on either side of it exceeds 16,000ft (5,000m) in places. Much of the river's course is in open valleys on the Tibetan Plateau, but in southeast Tibet it enters a deeply incised canyon through the eastern Himalayas, switching its course from northeast to southwest as it flows around Namcha Barwa. After 315 miles (505km), it emerges into the broad Brahmaputra valley.

▼ MULTIPLE STREAMS OF HOGENAKKAL FALLS

